Guitar Exercises - Section XIII, Level 91

Advanced Bend Intonation, Unison/Oblique Bends, Vibrato Architecture, Expressive Timing, and Dynamic Attack

Level 91 of 105. Section XIII begins here. HARD STOP after Level 105.

Hear the destination before bending to it. Pitch, width, rate, timing, attack, and release are all controlled variables.

Module	Exercise	Events
A	Bend calibration	144
B	Pre-bends and releases	128
C	Unison and oblique bends	144
D	Bent-note vibrato	128
E	Fretted-note vibrato	128
F	Dynamic attack and pick position	128
G	Expressive timing	112
H	Four phrase studies	192
I	32-bar capstone	256
J	Recovery/mastery	64
	TOTAL	1424

Bend Calibration

Bend	Semitones	Method
Quarter shade	~0.5	expressive color
Half	1	play target +1 fret, return, match
Whole	2	play target +2 frets, return, match
1.5 step	3	play target +3 frets, return, match
Pre-bend	chosen	bend silently, then attack
Release	reverse	hold target, descend evenly

Use a clean/lightly driven tone first. Record and verify consistency before adding more ornament.

Module A - Bend Intonation

Cell	Example	Task
1	B8 -> B9	half-step
2	B8 -> B10	whole-step
3	B8 -> B11	1.5-step
4	G7 -> G8	half-step
5	G7 -> G9	whole-step
6	e8 -> e10	whole-step
7	e10 -> e13	1.5-step
8	B10 -> B11	half-step + 2-beat hold

Use a clean/lightly driven tone first. Record and verify consistency before adding more ornament.

Timed Bend Arrivals

Arrival	Task
Beat 1	begin early; arrive exactly on 1
&1	source on 1, target on &
Beat 2	slow bend across beat 1
Beat 3	hold source 2 beats
Beat 4	late expressive arrival
&4	pickup into next chord

Use a clean/lightly driven tone first. Record and verify consistency before adding more ornament.

Module B - Pre-Bends and Releases

Cell	Action
1	pre-bend half step, attack, hold
2	pre-bend whole step, attack, hold
3	pre-bend whole, release
4	bend, hold, release
5	partial release and return
6	bend-release-rebend
7	pre-bend beat 4 -> release beat 1
8	silent setup after rest

Use a clean/lightly driven tone first. Record and verify consistency before adding more ornament.

Module C - Unison Bends

Fixed	Bent	Goal
e8 C	B8 -> C	beats disappear
e10 D	B10 -> D	2-beat hold
e12 E	B12 -> E	slow arrival
B8 G	G7 -> G	middle-string calibration
B10 A	G9 -> A	whole-step unison
e15 G	B15 -> G	upper register

Use a clean/lightly driven tone first. Record and verify consistency before adding more ornament.

Module C - Oblique Bends

Held voice	Moving voice	Task
high tonic	lower third bends	fixed voice stable
high fifth	lower fourth -> fifth	tension/release
upper chord tone	lower half-step bend	slow arrival
lower pedal	upper whole-step bend	reverse hierarchy
double-stop	one bends	do not pull fixed note
fixed note	bend + vibrato	vibrato moving voice only

Use a clean/lightly driven tone first. Record and verify consistency before adding more ornament.

Module D - Bent-Note Vibrato

Pass	Vibrato
1	none; hold target
2	narrow slow
3	narrow faster
4	wide slow
5	delayed 1 beat
6	3 pulses then centered target
7	pre-bend + delayed vibrato
8	vibrato before release

Use a clean/lightly driven tone first. Record and verify consistency before adding more ornament.

Module E - Fretted Vibrato

Type	Width/rate	Use
Narrow slow	small / 2-3 pulses	subtle sustain
Narrow fast	small / 4-6	intense
Wide slow	larger / 2	vocal emphasis
Delayed	chosen	pitch speaks first
Immediate	chosen	strong entry
Tempo-locked	eighth/triplet	rhythmic control

Use a clean/lightly driven tone first. Record and verify consistency before adding more ornament.

Module F - Dynamic Attack

Pass	Attack / position
1	pp near neck
2	mp middle
3	mf middle
4	f near bridge
5	crescendo, fixed position
6	same volume, neck -> bridge
7	accent first note only
8	accent target note only

Use a clean/lightly driven tone first. Record and verify consistency before adding more ornament.

Module G - Expressive Timing

Cell	Behavior
1	target exactly on beat
2	slightly delay final note
3	anticipate final note by eighth
4	hold penultimate longer
5	rest before target
6	bend early, arrive late
7	vibrato begins one beat late
8	rubato intro -> strict time

Use a clean/lightly driven tone first. Record and verify consistency before adding more ornament.

Module H - Study 1

Harmony: Am7-Dm7-E7-Am7

Focus: calibrated half/whole bends

Pass	Requirement
1	targets only
2	add articulation
3	add dynamics
4	add expressive timing
5	record clean
6	record performance tone

Module H - Study 2

Harmony: A7-D7-A7-E7

Focus: unison + oblique bends

Pass	Requirement
1	targets only
2	add articulation
3	add dynamics
4	add expressive timing
5	record clean
6	record performance tone

Module H - Study 3

Harmony: Cmaj7-Am7-Dm7-G7

Focus: vibrato contrasts

Pass	Requirement
1	targets only
2	add articulation
3	add dynamics
4	add expressive timing
5	record clean
6	record performance tone

Module H - Study 4

Harmony: G-D-Em-C

Focus: dynamic and timing arc

Pass	Requirement
1	targets only
2	add articulation
3	add dynamics
4	add expressive timing
5	record clean
6	record performance tone

Module I - 32-Bar Expression Capstone

Bars	Harmony	Focus
1-4	Am7-Dm7-E7-Am7	bend calibration
5-8	A7-D7-A7-E7	unison bends
9-12	Cmaj7-Am7-Dm7-G7	vibrato
13-16	G-D-Em-C	dynamic attack
17-20	Am7-E7-Am7-Am7	pre-bend/release
21-24	A7-D7-E7-A7	oblique bends
25-28	Cmaj7-A7-Dm7-G7	expressive timing
29-32	Am7-Dm7-E7-Am7	resolution/outro

One master tempo. Ornament density may change; form and chord targets may not.

Module J - Recovery and Mastery

Failure	Repair
Bend sharp/flat	play fretted target; retry without vibrato
Pre-bend scoops	set bend silently
Unison beating fast	slow near target and listen
Fixed oblique note moves	reduce grip
Vibrato falls below target	use smaller width
Dynamic accent rushes	mute strings; accent on grid
Expressive delay loses beat	use smaller delay
Form lost	chord tones only

Pass: 14/16 or better on two separate days; no zero in bend intonation, vibrato control, pulse, or recovery.

Next: Level 92 - rakes, grace notes, double-stop slides, natural/pinch harmonics, volume swells, muted attacks, and articulation chains.